

TOPIC 7: LITERATURE – PROSE

1. Study of the Recommended Text

Read the prescribed prose text carefully. Note the author, setting, main characters and the sequence of events. Keep a simple summary of each chapter or section.

2. Characterization

How the writer presents characters: through description, speech, actions and what others say about them. Identify major and minor characters; describe their traits and how they change (if at all).

3. Theme and Plot

Theme – the central idea or message (e.g. honesty, courage, conflict between tradition and change). **Plot** – the ordered sequence of events: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution. Be able to outline the plot and state themes with examples from the text.

4. Answering Questions on the Text

Use evidence from the book; quote or refer to specific incidents; explain how they support your answer. Avoid retelling the whole story when a focused point is required.

5. Summary

Prose study centres on characters, plot and themes in the recommended text. Support every point with reference to the work.

End of Topic 7